

Philipp Hilbert. *Technical Product Manager, AI Neobank.*

Positioning, fintech-native PM with 13 years in regulated products, a payment startup taken to acquisition, and AI platform delivery across defence and public sector.

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§ WHY BJAk

Bjak is doing something genuinely hard: building a single superapp that moves real money across payments, remittance, insurance, wealth, and trading in a region where regulatory patchwork and financial-rail fragility are the default conditions. The posting is explicit that reliability, auditability, and regulatory requirements are fundamental to the product, not edge cases, that framing matches how I think about fintech. The vertical ownership model (strategy through launch, including ledgering, reconciliation, and failure handling) is the scope I have operated at repeatedly, not something I am growing into. *That is the kind of product environment where careful technical judgment and speed are not in tension.*

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude Code**, in-repo spec and edge-case generation
- **GitHub Copilot**, ambient coding assist across Python and SQL
- **Cursor / VSCode**, LLM-assisted refactoring
- **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototyping
- **n8n**, agentic workflow orchestration
- **GPT**, research and evaluation loop drafting
- **Gamma.app**, stakeholder-facing decks
- **Framer**, design-heavy prototyping

§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Kubernetes, OpenShift, Docker, ArgoCD, GitOps rollout and rollback, Jenkins CI/CD, GitLab, Azure DevOps, REST APIs, Python, Kotlin with Spring Boot, Django, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka, Dagster, dbt, SQL-based funnel and churn analysis, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro.

§ SIDE PROJECT

CONSTRUCT8 [GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP](https://github.com/HilbertP) →

Two-sided B2B marketplace matching construction firms with workers, zero to one.

- Anonymity-until-payment model that protects both sides until commitment is made.
 - WhatsApp and Telegram as the primary product surface, keeping acquisition cost near zero.
 - LLM agents across the funnel so a single person runs the full day-to-day operation.
 - Demonstrates the exact combination Bjak needs: regulated financial mechanic, AI-assisted operations, and solo end-to-end delivery.
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§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT BJAK

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Shadow the payments and remittance flows end to end, ledger entries, reconciliation jobs, third-party rail touchpoints, failure paths, and map every assumption the current design makes about regulatory approval timing.

WEEK 2

Slice the critical path.

Identify the single gate most likely to block launch (regulatory approval, partner API SLA, or KYC limit logic) and draft the decision brief that lets engineering and compliance move in parallel rather than sequentially.

Ship, measure, close loops.

Own the first vertical's roadmap publicly: weekly written update to engineering, design, compliance, and operations so trade-offs are visible, decisions hold up under challenge, and money is always correct.

I COVER LETTER

Dear Hiring Team at Bjak,

I am applying for the Technical Product Manager role on your AI Neobank. The brief is unusually honest about what this work actually demands: money must be correct, AI is a means not the goal, and the PM owns the vertical from strategy through production. That framing resonates with me because it matches the environments I have worked in, not just the way I describe product management in interviews.

My closest reference point is Kvitt Payment Solutions, a mobile P2P payment product I co-founded and took from zero to acquisition inside the girocard ecosystem run by Sparkasse. Payments that move real money inside a regulated banking rail force a different level of precision on ledgering, reconciliation, failure handling, and compliance than most consumer products require. I learned early that a beautiful UX on top of a flaky settlement layer is not a product, it is a liability. That lesson has shaped how I approach every financial product since.

At Rohde & Schwarz I owned an internal AI and data platform for the FCAS defence programme, managing a cross-functional team of 15+ engineers and data scientists. The work included deciding where AI genuinely improved an outcome and where deterministic systems had to stay in control, a distinction the Bjak posting names explicitly. I also introduced GitOps delivery with ArgoCD that cut rollout time from days to 30 minutes and made the platform hotfix-capable, which matters when the underlying system is both mission-critical and multinational. At the Bundesagentur für Arbeit I held the Deputy IT Security Officer role while simultaneously migrating a bare-metal analytics platform into containers and shipping a full UI relaunch, regulatory constraints and delivery pressure at the same time, which is the normal condition at a fintech scaling across multiple Southeast Asian markets.

The insurance domain is one I know from two sides: as a product owner at CLINET (a mobile patient app interfacing with hospital information systems) and as a PM at EMIL Group, where I shipped the Claims Center from concept to production for a B2B SaaS platform serving insurers, reinsurers, and brokers. I cut time-to-market for a new insurance product from months to under a week there. Bjak's insurance vertical is not unfamiliar territory.

On the AI side I work daily with Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, Lovable, and n8n for agentic workflows. I have shipped products that use LLMs for evaluation, triage, and automation, and I have also killed AI features mid-delivery because the failure mode was unacceptable for the user context. Knowing when not to use AI is the harder discipline, and the posting singles it out for good reason.

I am available within four weeks of an offer and comfortable working across Southeast Asian time zones from Berlin. I would welcome a conversation about which vertical you would have me own first.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ BEARING

Product manager and product owner with 13 years of ownership in regulated, high-consequence domains including fintech, defence AI, public-sector analytics, insurance, and healthcare. I have co-founded and taken a payments product to acquisition inside a regulated banking ecosystem, owned AI and data platform delivery for a multinational defence programme, and held the Deputy IT Security Officer role alongside active roadmap delivery. I own verticals end to end, strategy, technical design, cross-functional alignment, and production launch, and I apply AI where it demonstrably improves an outcome and hold the line where deterministic systems must remain in control.

§ WHAT I CAN DO

Fintech and payments: P2P payment product design, regulated financial rails, ledgering, reconciliation, failure handling, PSP integration, KYC, transaction monitoring, girocard ecosystem

AI products and platform: LLM (large language model) agents, agentic workflows, evaluation loops, human-in-the-loop design, AI governance, EU AI Act, Explainable AI (XAI); full prototyping with Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, Lovable

Insurance and regulated domains: Claims Center delivery, B2B SaaS platform for insurers and reinsurers, mobile patient app, CGM interface, hospital information system (KIS) integration

Product management: continuous discovery, product vision and roadmap, prioritisation, MVP definition, PoC, A/B testing, user research, go-to-market support, product lifecycle management

Product ownership: requirements engineering, user stories, acceptance criteria, backlog refinement, sprint planning, velocity and burndown, UAT, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro

Agile and scaled delivery: Scrum, Kanban, SAFe (Scaled Agile Framework), ART (agile release train), PI (program increment) planning

SDLC and delivery: GitOps with ArgoCD, CI/CD, Jenkins, containerised environments, regression and end-to-end test automation, same-day hotfix paths, release gating

Data and analytics: ETL (extract, transform, load), Dagster, dbt (data build tool), PostgreSQL, funnel and churn analysis, KPI definition, MicroStrategy

Technical environments: Kubernetes (K8s), OpenShift, Docker, REST APIs, Python, Kotlin (Spring Boot), PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka, GitLab, Azure DevOps

Governance: GDPR (DSGVO), Deputy IT Security Officer, identity management, budget ownership, ROI reasoning

§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ROHDE & SCHWARZ · PRODUCT MANAGER · DEFENCE AI AND DATA PLATFORM 2024-2025

Cut rollout time from days to 30 minutes via GitOps with ArgoCD; increased pipeline runs 200% by redirecting strategy from UI-led to developer-code-first; led 15+ engineers and data scientists through Scrum on the FCAS AI and data platform.

BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT · PRODUCT MANAGER · PUBLIC-SECTOR ANALYTICS 2023-2024

Introduced Dagster and dbt, saving ~75% of time per data update; migrated a bare-metal system into containers; Deputy IT Security Officer alongside full roadmap delivery.

CLINET PLATFORMS · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTHCARE MOBILE APP 2023

Cut roadmap to top 10% of features; user acceptance rose fivefold. Implemented CGM interface into KIS workflows, reducing digital anamnesis from 30 minutes to 5.

EMIL GROUP · PRODUCT MANAGER · INSURANCE B2B SAAS PLATFORM 2022

Restructured an 18-person delivery organisation into three lean teams; shipped the Claims Center from concept to production; cut time-to-market for a new insurance product from months to under a week.

SCHEIDT & BACHMANN · PRODUCT OWNER · RETAIL AND PAYMENTS, POS
2021-2022

Moved research results into production in a full SAFe setup with agile release trains and PI planning.

BUNDESDRUCKEREI · PRODUCT OWNER (INTERIM) · SECURE DATA AND
IDENTITY 2021

Data structures and identity management for Robert Koch Institute programmes DIM and DESH.

AOK ITSCARE · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTH INSURANCE B2B PROCUREMENT
2019-2020

Migrated legacy system to Shopware for three AOK insurers and ~20,000 employees; still in production.

WALDBURG-ZEIL KLINIKEN · PRODUCT OWNER · CLINICAL NETWORK
INFRASTRUCTURE 2017-2018

Wifi rollout across nine hospitals.

§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

CONSTRUCT8 · FOUNDER AND PRODUCT MANAGER · CONSTRUCTION
STAFFING MARKETPLACE 2025-2026

Zero-to-one two-sided B2B marketplace; anonymity-until-payment model; LLM agents across the funnel; one operator runs the full day-to-day.

QCRYPT AG · CO-FOUNDER AND PRODUCT OWNER · QUANTUM-SECURE
ENCRYPTION 2016-2021

Shipped a three-layer hardware-software product that installs in under two minutes for enterprise buyers; later Chair of the Board.

SMART SOIL TECHNOLOGIES · CO-FOUNDER, CDO AND CFO ·
NANOTECHNOLOGY AND AGRICULTURE 2018-2021

Lab to investor rounds; owned financial planning and investor reporting.

KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS · FOUNDER AND CFO · FINTECH P2P
PAYMENTS 2013-2018

Built a mobile group-based P2P payment product from zero; acquired and operated by Sparkasse inside the girocard ecosystem.

§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

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TRUE NORTH · APPLICATION PACKAGE · BJAK

